

The Boston Globe

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THURSDAY, JANUARY 22, 2026

On the menu, Boston Harbor shellfish

State OK's harvesting from small area once blocked because of pollution

By Katie Muchnick
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Shellfish connoisseurs know their favorites like fine wines. The famed oysters of Wellfleet Harbor versus Island Creek from Duxbury; sublime steamers from Ipswich; sweet, tender mussels from Prince Edward Island.

And how about those soft-shell

clams from Winthrop and Hull?

That's not a misprint. For the first time in a century, the waters of Boston Harbor, once so polluted they were memorialized in the song "Dirty Water," are now clean enough that shellfish from its outer communities can be eaten without first running them through a purification plant. The turnaround is an-

other testament to a remarkable transformation of Boston Harbor since the 1980s.

The Massachusetts Division of Marine Fisheries recently said Winthrop, Hingham, and Hull can allow both recreational and commercial harvesting of shellfish in certain areas for direct human consumption. Currently, only a handful of commercial harvesters are allowed to sell shellfish from the harbor after they have been purified. But thousands more will soon

be able to get licenses from the three communities to harvest the briny treats much the way shellfishers and tourists on Cape Cod, for example, or coastal Maine can.

"I can literally go feed myself," said Chris Mancini, executive director of Save the Harbor/Save the Bay, which has advocated for the clean-up of Boston Harbor since 1986. "Or I could have a commercial permit and I can sell these."

Harvesting shellfish without pu-
SHELLFISH, Page A7

New ICE effort underway in Maine

Officials decry tactics used elsewhere, urge protesters to remain peaceful

By Lea Skene and Sabrina Shankman
GLOBE STAFF

PORTLAND, Maine — Federal immigration agents launched a new enforcement operation in Maine, the latest push under the Trump administration's mass deportation agenda that follows the president's recent attacks on Somali immigrants, who have a large presence in the state.

Portland residents reported seeing masked plainclothes officers in unmarked cars conducting traffic stops and detaining drivers. In some cases, observers heckled the officers, filmed their actions, and shouted messages of support to the immigrant detainees.

Immigration and Customs Enforcement officials confirmed the campaign Wednesday, calling it "Operation Catch of the Day."

The announcement followed reports of escalating immigration enforcement activity, especially in the Portland area, starting Tuesday morning. Local and state officials began warning of a potential surge last week.

Portland Mayor Mark Dion condemned the tactics immigration agents have used in other communities. He advised city residents to observe ICE activities without obstructing them.

PORTLAND, Page A6



PHOTOS BY ANDREW BURKE-STEVENSON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

LGBTQ hockey players, fans revel in TV show's moment

Gay romance in 'Heated Rivalry' affirms their place in a sport they love

By Christopher Muther
GLOBE STAFF

On Thursday night, TD Garden will be bathed in rainbow lights, and the Boston Bruins will festoon their sticks with rainbow-colored Pride Tape to celebrate the LGBTQ+ community during their annual Hockey Is for Everyone night. The event, which began nearly a decade ago, aims to "drive positive social change" and raise money for the Boston Pride Hockey league.

This year, you'll be hearing more about how Hockey Is for Everyone than usual, thanks to the HBO drama "Heated Rivalry." The show, which follows the steamy romance between two closeted professional hockey players, is having a viral moment that's transcended the LGBTQ+ community to become

HEATED, Page A10



Above, Tom McCoy (34, center) subbed out during a Boston Pride Hockey game in Revere on Sunday. Left, hockey sticks wrapped with rainbow tape sat outside the locker rooms after the game.

Trump claims start of deal for Greenland

Drops tariff threat, says he won't use force to take over

By Lara Jakes, Jim Tankersley, and Zolan Kanno-Youngs
NEW YORK TIMES

BRUSSELS — President Trump said Wednesday that he had reached the framework of a deal with NATO over Greenland's future, hours after alliance officials separately discussed the possibility of the United States obtaining sovereignty over land for military bases, according to three senior officials familiar with the talks.

Trump's announcement was among a series of moves Wednesday that appeared to draw the United States back from the possibility of military and economic conflict with his allies over Greenland, an autonomous territory of Denmark.

Trump also withdrew the threat of additional tariffs for European allies that had resisted his insistence on owning Greenland, and said he would not use force to assert US ownership.

Trump capped those concessions Wednesday evening with an announcement on Truth Social that he and Mark Rutte, the NATO secretary-general, had "formed the framework of a future deal

TRUMP, Page A4

Patriots fans happy to be on familiar turf

After Sunday win, visions of dynasty dance in their heads

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF
and Lauren Albano
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Until this month, the New England Patriots had gone seven years without winning a playoff game, a blink of an eye for many teams in the National Football League, but it felt like a crawl across a success-parched desert for Boston fans.

Their startling rebound this season has made many fans feel, well, entitled.

"Seven years to the older fans is an eternity, based on what the Patriots had accomplished so easily" for two decades, said David Crowley, 42, who manages The Greatest Bar near North Station.

"It felt out of place," he added. "But this

PATRIOTS, Page A10



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Patriots fans celebrated at Sunday's game against the Houston Texans.



Comfort, cold

Thursday: Partly sunny.
High: 41-46. Low: 22-27.

Friday: Mostly cloudy, colder.
High: 29-34. Low: 3-8

Sunrise: 7:07 Sunset: 4:45

Comics and Weather, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

VOL. 309, NO. 22

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



The Supreme Court seemed inclined to keep Federal Reserve governor Lisa Cook in her job, casting doubt on President Trump's bid to wrest control of the nation's central bank. A2.

Several polls show a majority of Latin Americans endorsed President Trump's intervention in Venezuela. A3.

State Auditor Diana DiZoglio said her office plans to sue Massport for additional records after finding that the agency executed a nearly \$1.4 million settlement that included confidentiality and nondisclosure clauses to prevent claims of discrimination. **B1.**

Massachusetts can't afford to lose the burn unit at Brigham and Women's Hospital, nurses there testified as they urged the state to deem the service "essential" amid a proposed merger. **D1.**